ID I BAPS

Institut D'Investigacions Biomèdiques August Pi i Sunyer

WORKSHOP ON CRAFTING A IMPACTFUL GRANT PROPOSAL

26th June 2026

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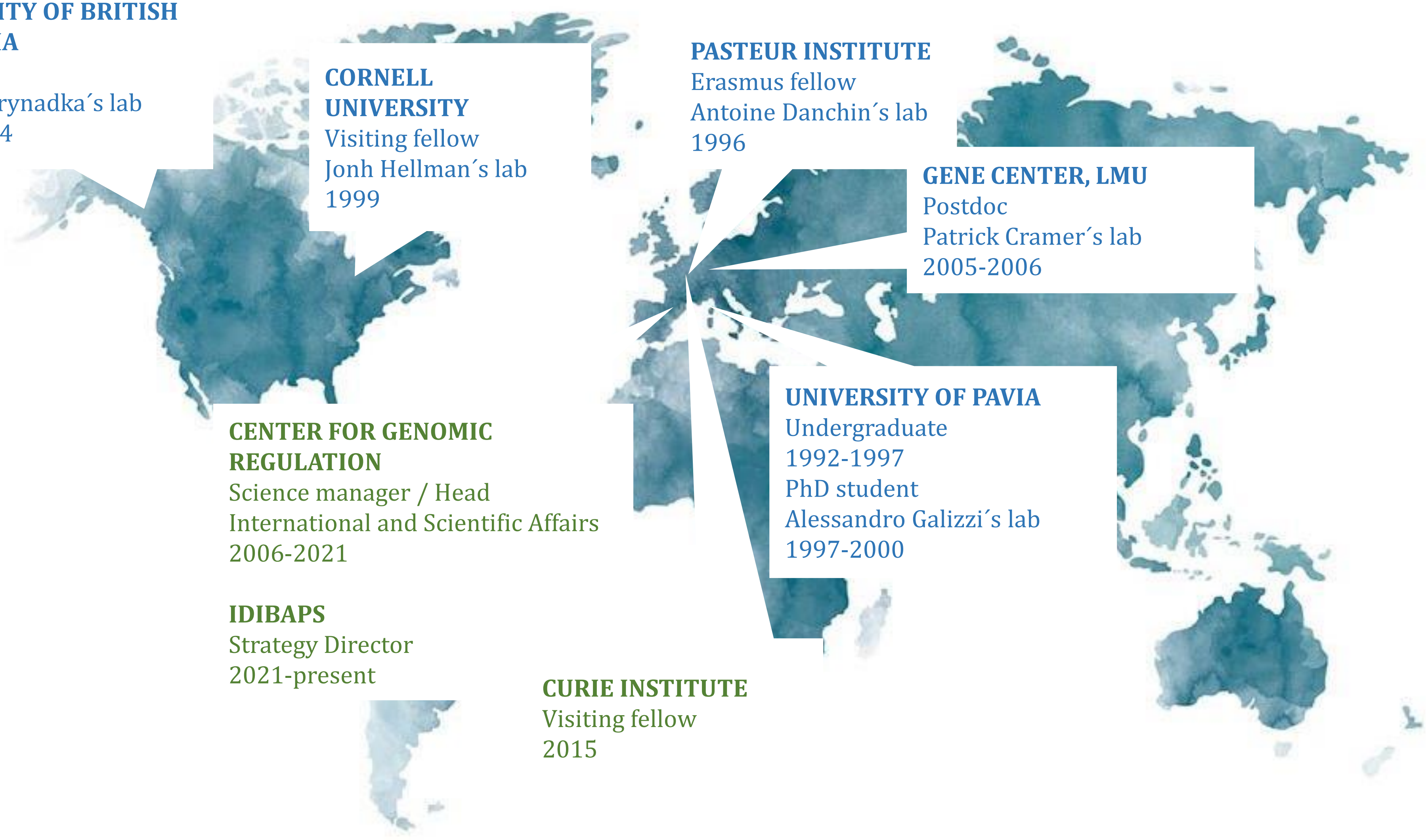
A brief introduction about myself



Research and countries hopping

UNIVERSITY OF BRITISH COLUMBIA
Postdoc
Natalie Strynadka´s lab
2001-2004

CORNELL UNIVERSITY
Visiting fellow
Jonh Hellman´s lab
1999

PASTEUR INSTITUTE
Erasmus fellow
Antoine Danchin´s lab
1996

GENE CENTER, LMU
Postdoc
Patrick Cramer´s lab
2005-2006

UNIVERSITY OF PAVIA
Undergraduate
1992-1997
PhD student
Alessandro Galizzi´s lab
1997-2000

CENTER FOR GENOMIC REGULATION
Science manager / Head
International and Scientific Affairs
2006-2021

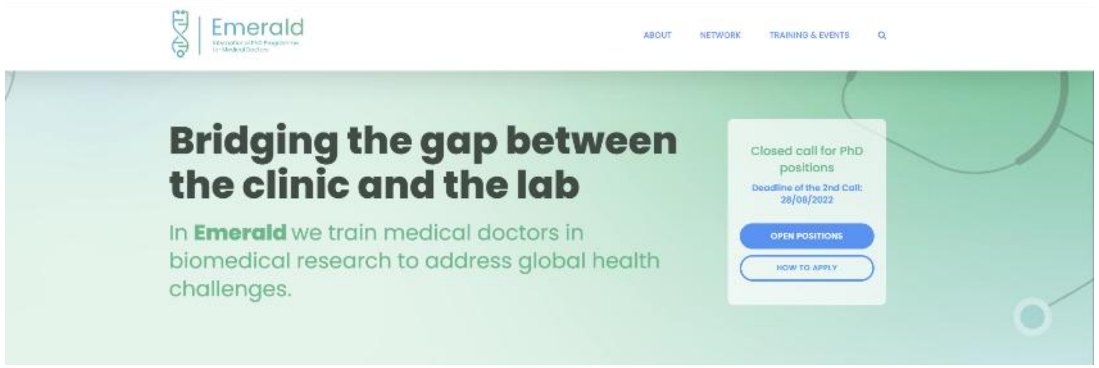
IDIBAPS
Strategy Director
2021-present

CURIE INSTITUTE
Visiting fellow
2015

I like grant writing!

…experience in failures and some successes

- Travel grants
- Individual grants to support my research
- Collaborative grants – open science, education, gender equality
- Institutional grants



Participants' introduction and expectations

Active poll

17

Have you ever written a fellowship / grant proposal?

No

53%

Yes, several times

29%

Yes, once or twice

18%

Join at

slido.com

#3596 636

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Active poll

22

What would you like to learn from this workshop?

Proposal writing
How to write a grant winning applications
Available Fellowships for PhD and how to access them
available
What needs to be included
Key points to highlight
avoid
How to win competitive grants
Mechanics
proposals
How to write a grant
research
Neuroscience
award
Grant writing
grant
writing
write
winning
Sourcing
Computational
mistakes
What reviewers check
grants
Decision Making
How to write a grant proposal.
How to make budgeting
I want to win
How to write and win the grant

Join at
slido.com
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Expected learning outcomes

- Develop your “grant strategy”
- Write for your audience – the reviewer
- Craft and write the different sections of a grant proposal
- Exchange “tips and tricks”

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"There is no grantsmanship that will turn a bad idea into a good one, but there are many ways to disguise a good idea"

Norm Braverman, NIH


8:22
NIKITA


LA CIUTAT I ELS XIQUETS DE VALLS
En commemoració de la
Proclamació dels castells com a
Patrimoni Immaterial de la Humanitat
per la UNESCO
Valls, ciutat bressol dels castells

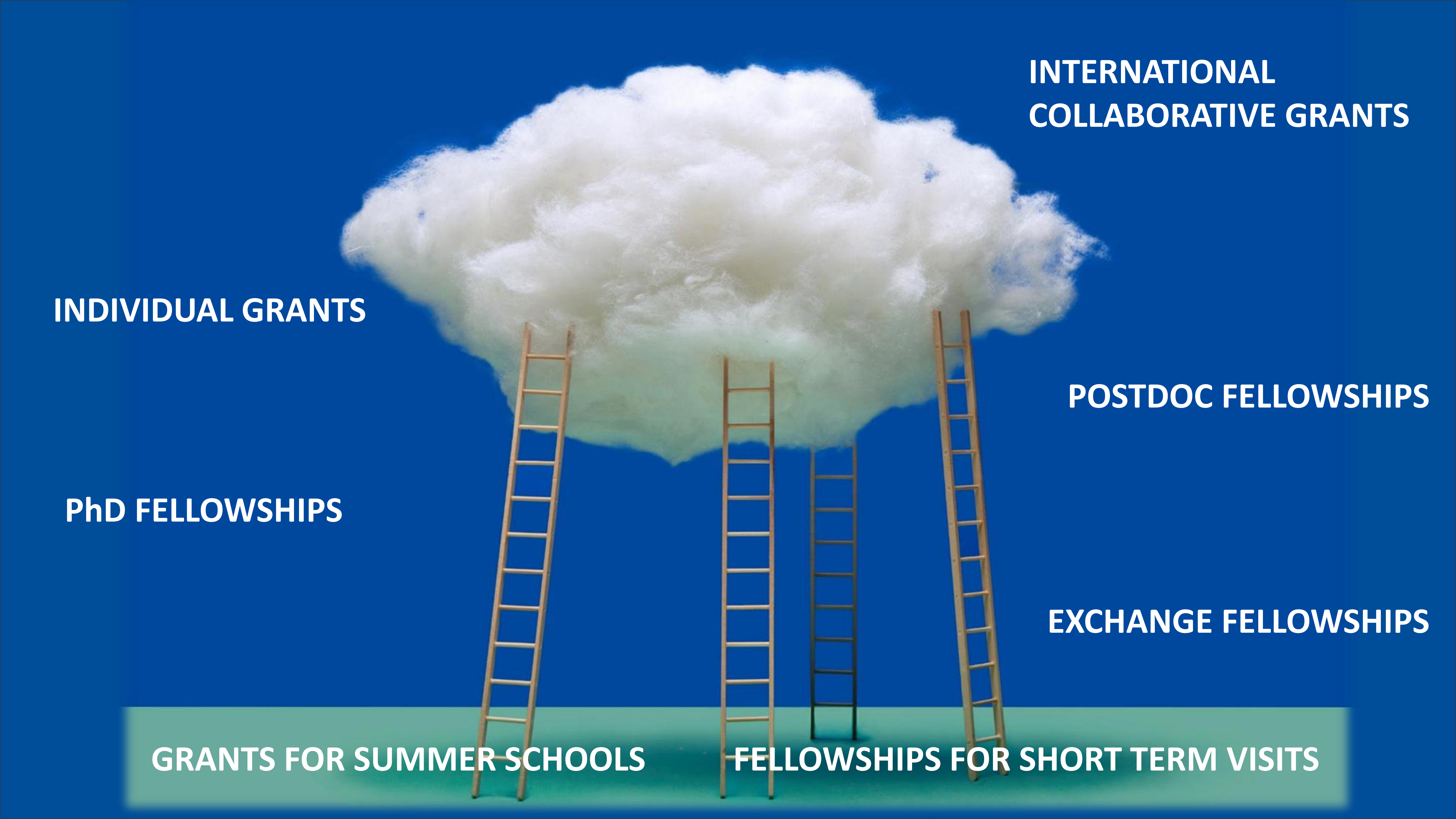
OUTLINE

1. Defining your grant strategy
2. Finding a grant opportunity
3. Understanding evaluation process and criteria
4. Crafting the different sections of a grant

1. GRANT STRATEGY

Establishing your strategy…

1. Identify your **research niche**
   - *What problem / question would you like to solve?*
   - *What are the gaps in your field?*
2. Identify and understand your **funding niche/s**
   - *Why is the funder interested in your problem?*
3. Get help from experienced **mentors/peers/collaborators** and grant/research managers
4. Get to know **previous grantees** in your own field and read **previous applications**


INTERNATIONAL COLLABORATIVE GRANTS
INDIVIDUAL GRANTS
POSTDOC FELLOWSHIPS
PhD FELLOWSHIPS
EXCHANGE FELLOWSHIPS
GRANTS FOR SUMMER SCHOOLS
FELLOWSHIPS FOR SHORT TERM VISITS

2. FINDING A GRANT OPPORTUNITY

…as an early-stage or experienced researcher

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INTERNATIONAL BRAIN RESEARCH ORGANIZATION (IBRO)

ARUA African Research Universities Alliance

EMBO

MARIE CURIE ACTIONS

SCIENCE FOR AFRICA FOUNDATION

Africa Oxford Initiative 10 YEARS of collaboration

ARUA African Research Universities Alliance

FUNDACIÓN MUJERES POR ÁFRICA

AREF Africa Research Excellence Fund

AAS The African Academy of Sciences

BIOCHEMICAL SOCIETY

The Physiological Society

unesco twas THE WORLD ACADEMY OF SCIENCES for the advancement of science in developing countries

NIH Fogarty International Center

HFSP International Human Frontier Science Program Organization

wellcome

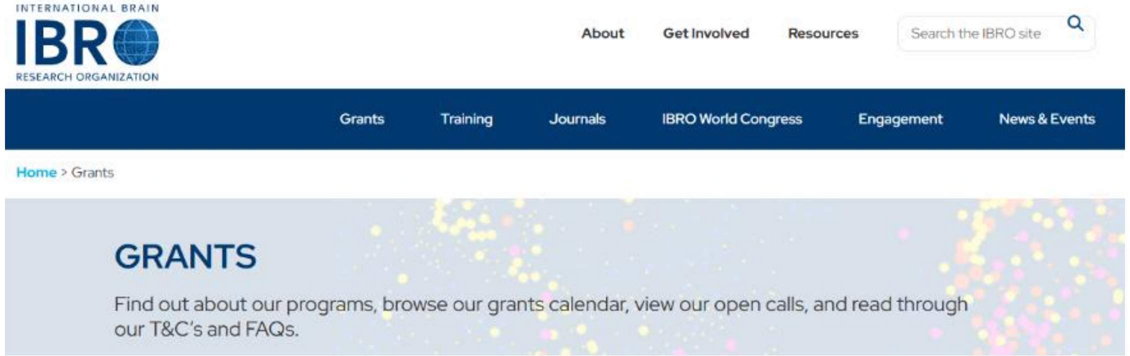
HORIZON EUROPE

Ask other researchers, grants experts or ChatGTP…

Summer Schools and Courses

- **Neuromatch academy**: computational neuroscience course ONLINE.: https://compneuro.neuromatch.io/tutorials/intro.html
- **Computational Biology** in University of Coimbra: https://www.uc.pt/events/computationalbiology/
- **Fred Kavli Knowledge Center** Mathematical Methods in Computational Neuroscience, Eresfjord, Norway: https://www.compneuronrsn.org/?utm_source=chatgpt.com
- **EMBO training**
  - Developmental biology: from cells to neural systems
  - https://www.embo.org/conferences-training/#/
- **Cold Spring Harbor Laboratory Neuroscience Courses & Workshops**
  - Computational Neuroscience Vision
  - The 2026 *Drosophila* Neurobiology: Genes, Circuits & Behavior
  - 2026/2027 Neuroscience courses and workshops

Short-term exchange fellowships



- PhD neuroscience students, early-career postdocs
- International exchanges, within or outside Africa
- Travel and local expenses
- https://ibro.org/grants/

- Early-career researchers at African universities, holding a PhD
- 6-month fellowships
- Collaborations with highly experienced and distinguished researchers at ARUA Centers of Excellence
- At least 70% of the fellowships are reserved for female candidates; applicants no older than 35 years.
- https://arua.org/early-career-research-fellowships/

From travel to research grants...

BIOCHEMICAL
SOCIETY

Grants and Bursaries

The Biochemical Society offers a programme of grants for all career stages supporting research, attendance at scientific conferences, and the sponsorship of events. Members of the Biochemical Society are also eligible for FEBS Fellowships and IUBMB Fellowships.

https://www.biochemistry.org/grants-and-awards/grants-and-bursaries/

CONFERENCE AND TRAVEL GRANTS

General Travel Grants

Funding of up to £1,000 to support attendance at face-to-face scientific meetings, workshops, and training courses.

CONFERENCE AND TRAVEL GRANTS

Lab Visit Grants

Funding of up to £2,000 is available to support collaborative visits to UK and international laboratories.

RESEARCH GRANTS

STUDENTS

Krebs Memorial Scholarship

This scholarship provides funding during a PhD and rewards exceptional academic distinction.

RESEARCH GRANTS

Eric Reid Fund for Methodology

This fund provides modest financial support for benchwork. The emphasis is on methodology, with a preference for cellular or bioanalytical work.

Fellowships and grants for women

- Promote African women’s leadership in science and technology
- 6-month post-doctoral fellowship in Spanish research centre
- Over 190 talented women supported
- Upcoming deadline 30th June 2026!
- https://mujeresporafrica.es/science-by-women-convocatoria/

- Women in Science Sub-Saharan Africa Programme
- Research grants for 30 doctoral and 8 post doctoral research candidate
- Training in Leadership, Management, Negotiation and Communication
- https://www.forwomeninscience.com/map/

Horizon Europe as an opportunity

Bottom-up	Top-down	Bottom-up/ Top-down
Pillar 1 Excellent Science	**Pillar 2** Global Challenges and European Industrial Competitiveness	**Pillar 3** Innovative Europe
European Research Council	Clusters: Health; Culture, Creativity and Inclusive Society; Civil Security for Society; Digital, Industry and Space; Climate, Energy and Mobility; Food, Bioeconomy, Natural Resources, Agriculture and Environment	European Innovation Council
Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions		European innovation ecosystems
Research Infrastructures	Joint Research Centre	European Institute of Innovation and Technology

Widening Participation and Strengthening the European Research Area

- Widening participation and spreading excellence
- Reforming and Enhancing the European R&I system

Horizon Europe as an opportunity

Bottom-up

Pillar 1
Excellent Science

European Research Council

Marie Skłodowska-Curie Actions

Research Infrastructures

Widening Participation and

Widening participation and spreading excel

MSCA

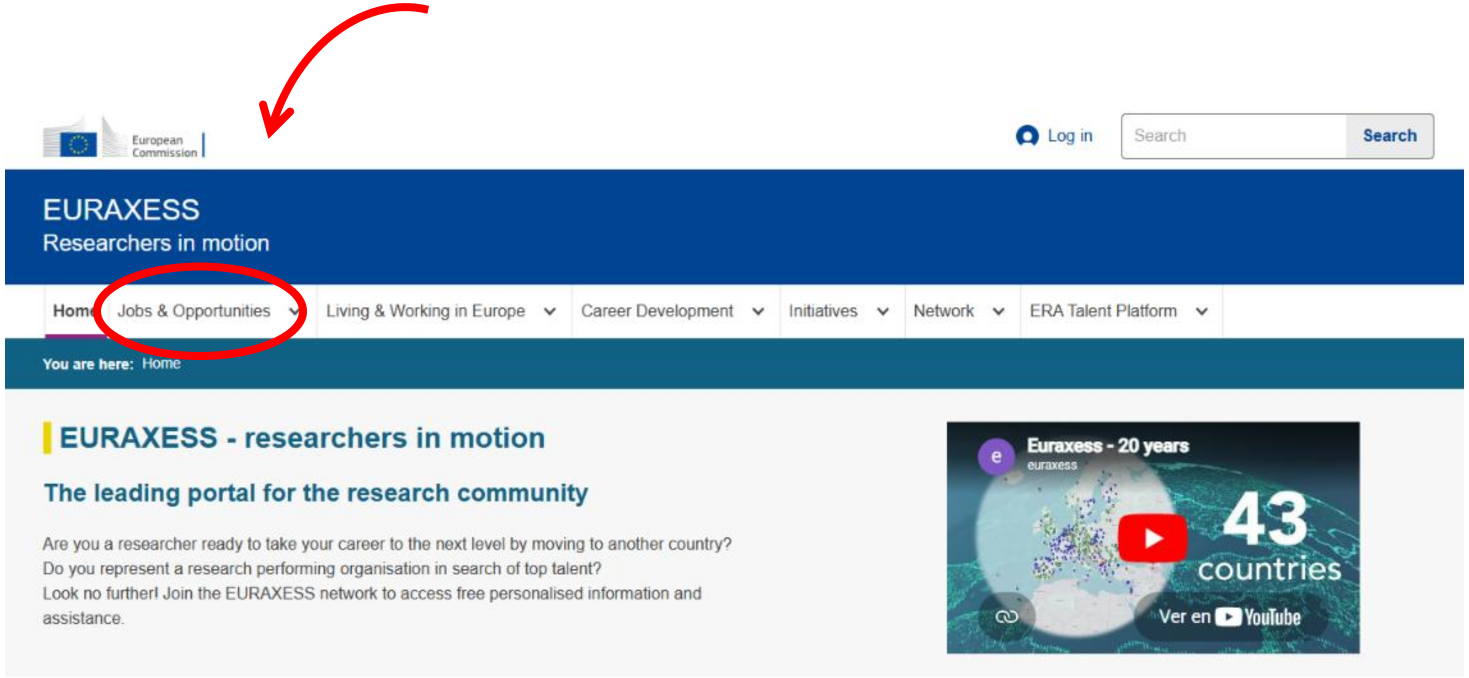
- EU's reference programme for doctoral and postdoctoral training
- Open to all fields of research and innovation
- Acquire ***new knowledge and skills***, through ***mobility*** across borders and ***exposure to different sectors and discipline***

- **Doctoral Networks (DN):** Doctoral programmes in a consortia of universities, research institutions and research infrastructures, SMEs, other companies

- **Postdoctoral Fellowships (PF):** Individual fellowships
  - ➢ **European PF:** coming to Europe from any country or moving within EU
  - ➢ **Global PF:** outgoing phase outside EU + mandatory return phase in EU

European Commission

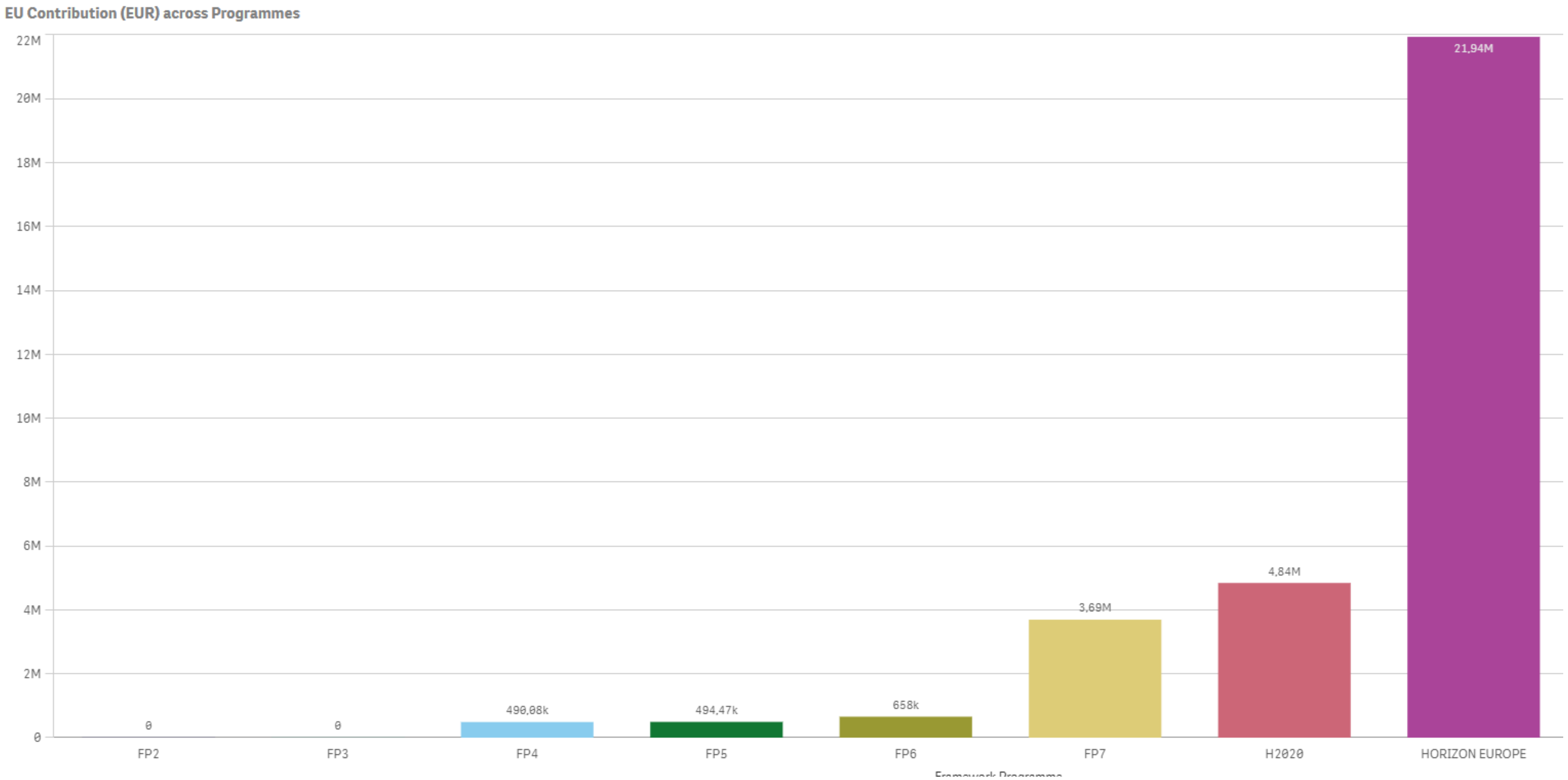
EURAXESS Portal for opportunities in Europe



- Largest pan-European initiative to foster researchers' mobility and career development
- Strengthening scientific collaboration between Europe and the global community
- Search jobs – e.g.. "MSCA Doctoral Networks", "Neuroscience"…

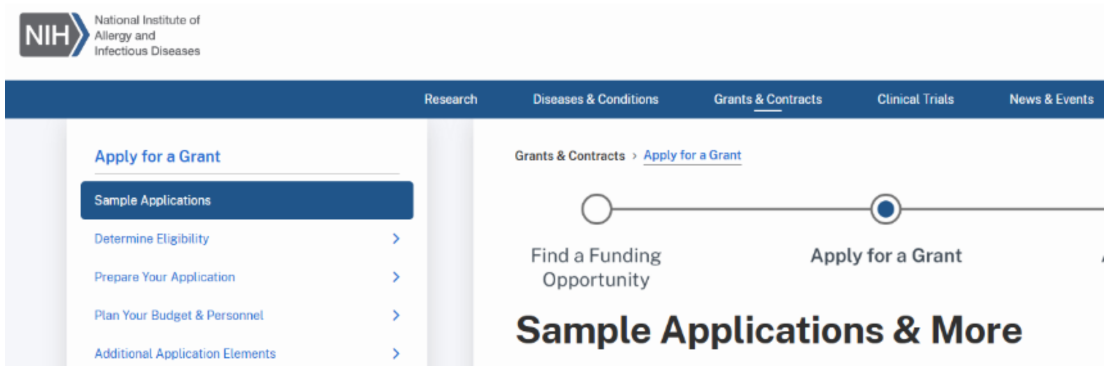
https://euraxess.ec.europa.eu/

Nigeria participation in Horizon Europe



Open repositories of grant applications

https://www.ogrants.org/



https://www.niaid.nih.gov/grants-contracts/sample-applications

https://www.ffg.at/europa/heu/erc/published-proposals

TIP - Excellent matching...

- Understanding the goals of the funders (motivation, vision, policy background)
- Understanding the call´s requirements
- Aligning your proposed research with the call´s objectives of the funding agency
- Read other submitted grants and reviews, if available

3. EVALUATION: PROCESS AND CRITERIA

- STUDY FUNDER´S GOALS
- UNDERSTAND PROCESSES AND CRITERIA OF EVALUATION

Quote from Dr. Juan Valcarcel

Example of evaluation **criteria** – IBRO exchange

1. **Scientific Credentials:** academic and publication record, relevant work experience
2. **Quality of Research Proposal:** high standard of work in a significant research area, with clear aims, objectives, and a structured plan.
3. **Quality and Commitment of Host Lab:** good reputation in the applicant's research area(s), strong commitment to support the proposed research, and matching research funds.
4. **Letters of Reference**
5. **Benefit for the Applicant & Value to Home Lab:** justified the need for the fellowship, and the value it brings to their home lab (through knowledge transfer, collaboration, etc.).

[Exchange Fellowships - IBRO]

Example of evaluation **criteria** – Wellcome Early Career Award

Scope

- Early-career researchers from any discipline.
- Advance understanding in your field and/or develop methodologies, conceptual frameworks, tools or techniques that could benefit health-related research.

Research proposal (50%)

Bold, creative, high-quality

Skills and experience (25%)

Previous experience, outputs. Plans for skill development

Research environment (25%)

Research and administrative support. Future plans to contribute to a positive Research culture.

[Early-Career Awards – Funding for Early-Career Researchers | Wellcome]

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Write your grant for the reviewer

4. WRITING TIPS

General tips

1. Answer the **mission of the funding agency**
2. Write the proposal **for the evaluators**
3. Find the right **balance**: the proposal should be focused, original, novel.....of course feasible!
4. Aim your proposal to both at an **expert** and at a **generalist**
5. **Structure** well your proposal: hypothesis, objectives, methodology, contingency plans
6. **Ask** colleagues / mentors
7. Prepare your timeline, do not wait until the last minute and **enjoy** the process

Grant style

- Structure and organize the text
- Make the text “*a joy to read*”
- “*A picture is worth a thousand of words*”
- Keep your application to allowed number of pages and “rules”
- Check spelling and grammar

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Grant style

Relevance to the European Scientific objectives

Exciting new developments and discoveries provide the unprecedented opportunity to study the molecular pathophysiology of aneuploidy. These include i) the near-completion of the nucleotide sequence of the euchromatic portion of the human genome ii) the completion of the sequence of the laboratory mouse and other species iii) the identification of the most common sequence variants (SNPs) in certain human populations iv) the development of technological platforms to detect hundreds of thousands of SNPs as well as measure genomic copy number variation (CNV) throughout the human genome v) the development of methods to assess the level of gene expression for virtually all protein-coding genes vi) the availability of bioinformatic tools for data analysis and integration, and vii) the development of methodologies for creation of model mice with engineered large-scale and fine-scale aneuploidies. This present proposal utilizes all of the above achievements to tackle the fundamental question of gene dosage imbalance. Investigators in Europe were major contributors in research topics related to aneuploidy. European laboratories: 1/ enjoyed leading positions on the sequencing efforts of the HSA21 and its chimp homologue; 2/ were leading in creating an atlas of gene expression of all HSA21 genes in the mouse; 3/ were leading in studying the functions of numerous genes sensitive to dosage imbalance; 4/ were leaders in mouse trangenesis and mutagenesis; 5/ considerably contributed to the hapmap project; 6/ considerably contributed to the understanding of gene expression variation; 7/ were pioneers in recognising the functional importance of conserved non-coding regions of the mammalian genome; 8/ European laboratories and clinical investigators have described several aneuploidy syndromes; 9/ have considerably contributed to the methodology of detection of gene copy number variation; 10/ have conducted important preliminary studies to detect polymorphic copy number variation in European populations. This grant proposal builds on the existing outstanding expertise and European research infrastructure. Thus this grant proposal maintains the competitive excellence of European Science in the field of functional genome analysis and in particular of aneuploidy. This will be addressed in details in part B7. We wish to emphasize here that several members of this present consortium of partners have successfully collaborated in the past in funded European projects and produced high impact papers. This collaboration dates from the late 1980's and has created a powerful infrastructure, extensive collaborations, training and exchange of personnel. In addition, the collaborative projects have trained young investigators in the fields of genome analysis and aneuploidy and has thus (in these fields) stopped the brain drain to US laboratories. Furthermore, the collaborative funded projects provided the opportunity to attract outstanding young and more mature investigators back to European laboratories. The complexity of the biological problem of aneuploidies and gene dosage imbalance (or better yet genomic region dosage imbalance) is such that scientists from one discipline have a limited probability of making significant advances. Thus this grant proposal mobilizes the experts of diverse disciplines such as clinical phenotyping, diagnostic laboratory expertise, molecular biology, cellular biology, mouse phenotyping, mouse genomic engineering, functional genome analysis, bioinformatics, systems biology, protein biochemistry and analysis, molecular neuroscientists, behavioural neuroscientists, statisticians, and science administrators. The continuous interactions of these scientists and the integration of data acquisition and data analysis provide and added value to the project and make it bigger than a simple addition of each individual component.
The integration of the individual parts and the interrelation of the WPs make this project compatible with the European principles for scientific integration and development/maintenance of excellence in the various geographic compartments of Europe.

Relevance to the European Scientific objectives

Why now?
Exciting new developments and discoveries provide the unprecedented opportunity to study the molecular pathophysiology of aneuploidy. These include i) the near-completion of the nucleotide sequence of the euchromatic portion of the human genome ii) the completion of the sequence of the laboratory mouse and other species iii) the identification of the most common sequence variants (SNPs) in certain human populations iv) the development of technological platforms to detect hundreds of thousands of SNPs as well as measure genomic copy number variation (CNV) throughout the human genome v) the development of methods to assess the level of gene expression for virtually all protein-coding genes vi) the availability of bioinformatic tools for data analysis and integration, and vii) the development of methodologies for creation of model mice with engineered large-scale and fine-scale aneuploidies. This present proposal utilizes all of the above achievements to tackle the fundamental question of gene dosage imbalance.

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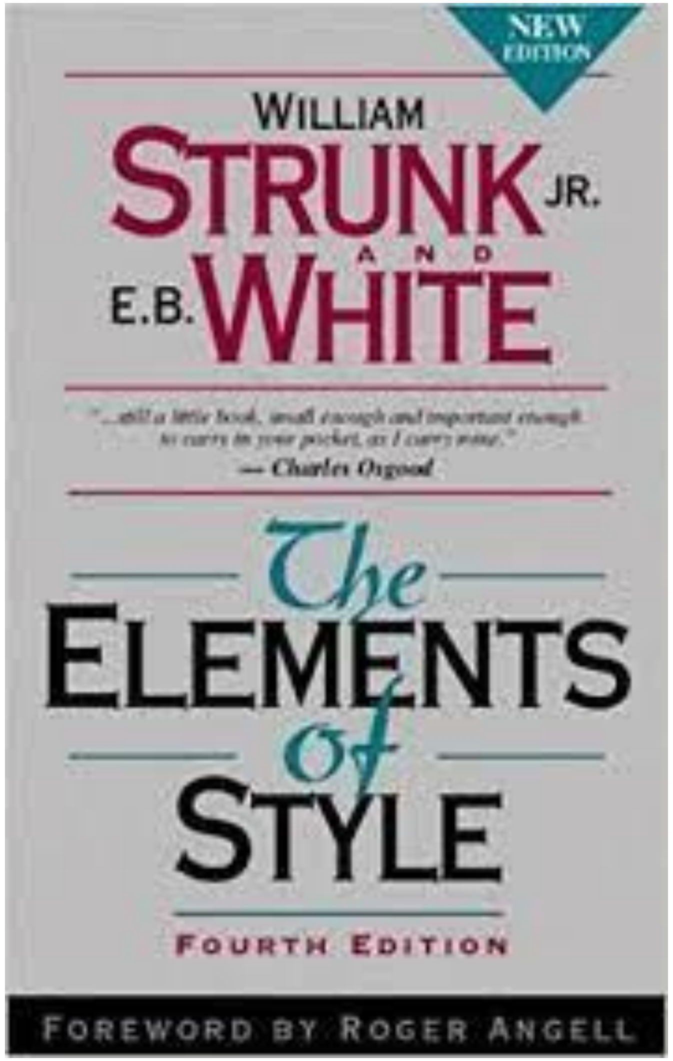
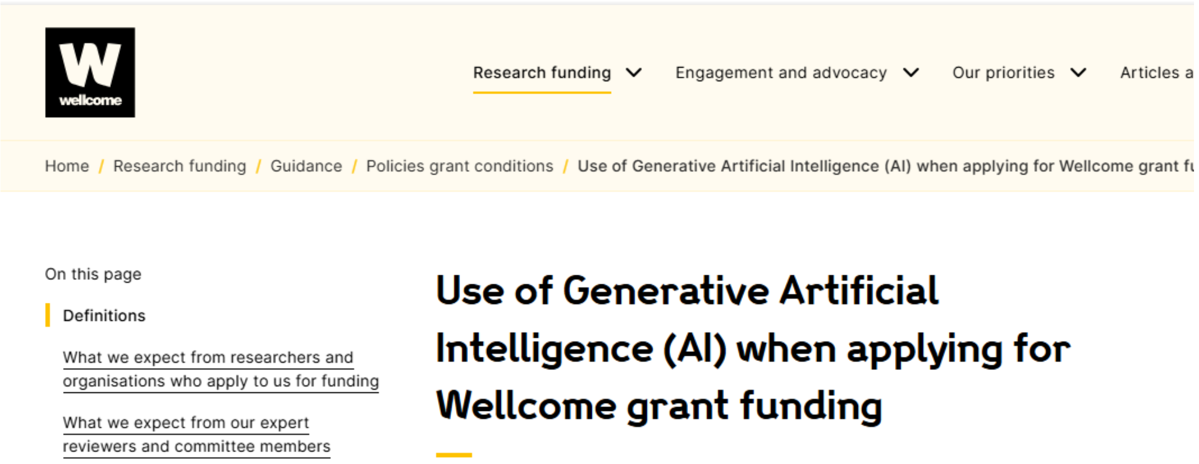
Clear English, not too wordy...



Clear English, not too wordy...

Using generative AI for grant writing

https://research-and-innovation.ec.europa.eu/news/all-research-and-innovation-news/guidelines-responsible-use-generative-ai-research-developed-european-research-area-forum-2024-03-20_en



[Use of generative AI - Funding Policy | Wellcome]

[Guidance on the use of Artificial Intelligence in the development and review of research grant proposals]

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Using generative AI for grant writing

RECOMMENDATIONS FOR RESEARCHERS

1. Remain **ultimately responsible** for scientific output.
2. Use generative AI **transparently**.
3. Pay particular attention to issues related to **priva**… **property** rights when sharing sensitive or protected i…
4. When using generative A… and international legislation, as in their regular resea…
5. C… …ative AI tools properly to maximise their benefits, including by
…using generative AI tools substantially[19] in sensitive activities that could impact other …esearchers or organisations (for example peer review, evaluation of research proposals, etc).

BE ORIGINAL, AUTHENTIC, CREATIVE

https://research-and-innovation.ec.europa.eu/news/all-research-and-innovation-news/guidelines-responsible-use-generative-ai-research-developed-european-research-area-forum-2024-03-20_en

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Common sections of a research grant application

- Abstract / Summary
- Your expertise
- Goals and specific objectives
- State-of-the-art and rational
- Methodology / Research plan
- Expected outcomes and impact
- Budget

Abstract

1. *Why bother?*

2. *What do you want to do?*

3. *How?*

4. *What will be the impact of your project?*

Neural circuit dynamics underlying expectation and their impact on the variability of perceptual choices

Just as our experience has its origin in our perceptions, our perceptions are fundamentally shaped by our experience. How does the brain build expectations from experience and how do expectations impact perception? In a Bayesian framework, expectations determine the environment's prior probability, which combined with stimulus information, can yield optimal decisions. While the accumulation-to-bound model describes temporal integration of sensory inputs and their combination with the prior, we still lack electrophysiological evidence showing neural circuits that integrate previous events adaptively to generate advantageous expectations.

Why bother?

I aim to understand (1) how circuits in the cerebral cortex integrate the recent history of stimuli and rewards to generate expectations, (2) how expectations are combined with sensory input across the processing hierarchy to bias decisions and (3) whether the dynamics of the expectation can dominate neuronal and choice variability. I will train rats in a new auditory discrimination task using predictable stimulus sequences that, once learned, are used to compute adaptive priors that improve discrimination. I will perform population recordings and optogenetic manipulations to identify the brain areas involved in the computation of priors in the task. To reveal the circuit mechanisms underlying the observed dynamics I will train a computational network model to classify fluctuating inputs and, by adapting its dynamics to the statistics of the stimulus sequence, accumulate evidence across trials to maximize performance. The model will generalize the accumulation-to-bound model by integrating information across various time scales and will partition choice variability into that caused by the dynamics of the prior or by fluctuations in the stimulus response. My proposal points at a paradigm shift from viewing neuronal variability as a corrupting source of noise to the result of our brain's inevitable tendency to predict the future.

What do you want to do?

How?

What will be the impact of your project?

TIPS - Abstract (the “killer”)

- First part to be read - first & last part to be written
- Brief summary of your project
- Aimed at an expert and a generalist
- Some reviewers might read only the abstract
- Clear & Concise & Complete –*“Less is more”*
- Double-check spelling and avoid abbreviations

Your expertise

TIPS – Your expertise

- Why you?
- Align experience and expertise, previous training with the project goals
- Use evidence (publications, abstracts, etc.)
- Show synergies and complementarity of the team, if relevant

Goals and specific objectives

Main Goal = ultimate global purpose of the project

Specific Objectives = action steps towards the goal, focused and clear

Tip – Maintain the same structure of objectives throughout the whole proposal (e.g., excellence & implementation)

Goal and objectives/aims – example

Overall Goal

To determine how APOE4 and age-related biological changes contribute to early Alzheimer's disease pathology and identify biomarkers for timely intervention

Specific Aim 1 - Characterize early brain changes associated with APOE4.

Use neuroimaging and fluid biomarkers to identify alterations in brain structure and function before cognitive symptoms emerge.

Specific Aim 2 - Determine how hormonal and metabolic factors interact with APOE4 risk.

Investigate whether menopause-related biological changes modify Alzheimer's-associated pathways and brain vulnerability.

Specific Aim 3 - Identify predictive biomarkers of future cognitive decline.

Integrate genetic, imaging, and molecular measures to improve prediction of Alzheimer's disease progression.

State-of-the-art (SOA)

❑ **Structure for Clarity**
- Break the SOA into short, focused sub-sections with clear sub-headings
- Identify existing knowledge gaps
- State how your project advances the field beyond the SOA
- Use up-to-date references to support your claims

❑ **Showcase Your or the Team Expertise**
- Present preliminary data, if available

❑ **Drive Your Message Home**
- Bold statement or text box summarizing how your project pushes the boundaries of current research

TIPS – Beyond the state-of-the-art

- Educate the evaluator…but do not bore her/him
- What is known? What is not known? Why is it essential to find out?
- Where your proposal fits, what gaps will address
- Make sure to cite all the relevant and up to date literature
- Establish your competence and credibility – include preliminary data if available.
- Consider including a figure summarizing difficult problems, processes, etc.

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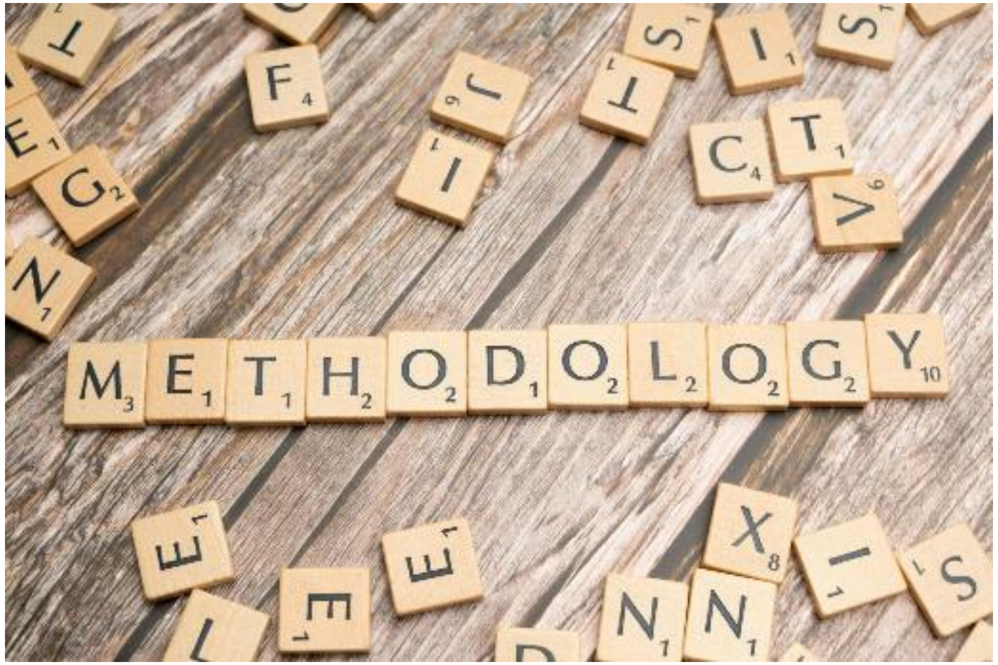
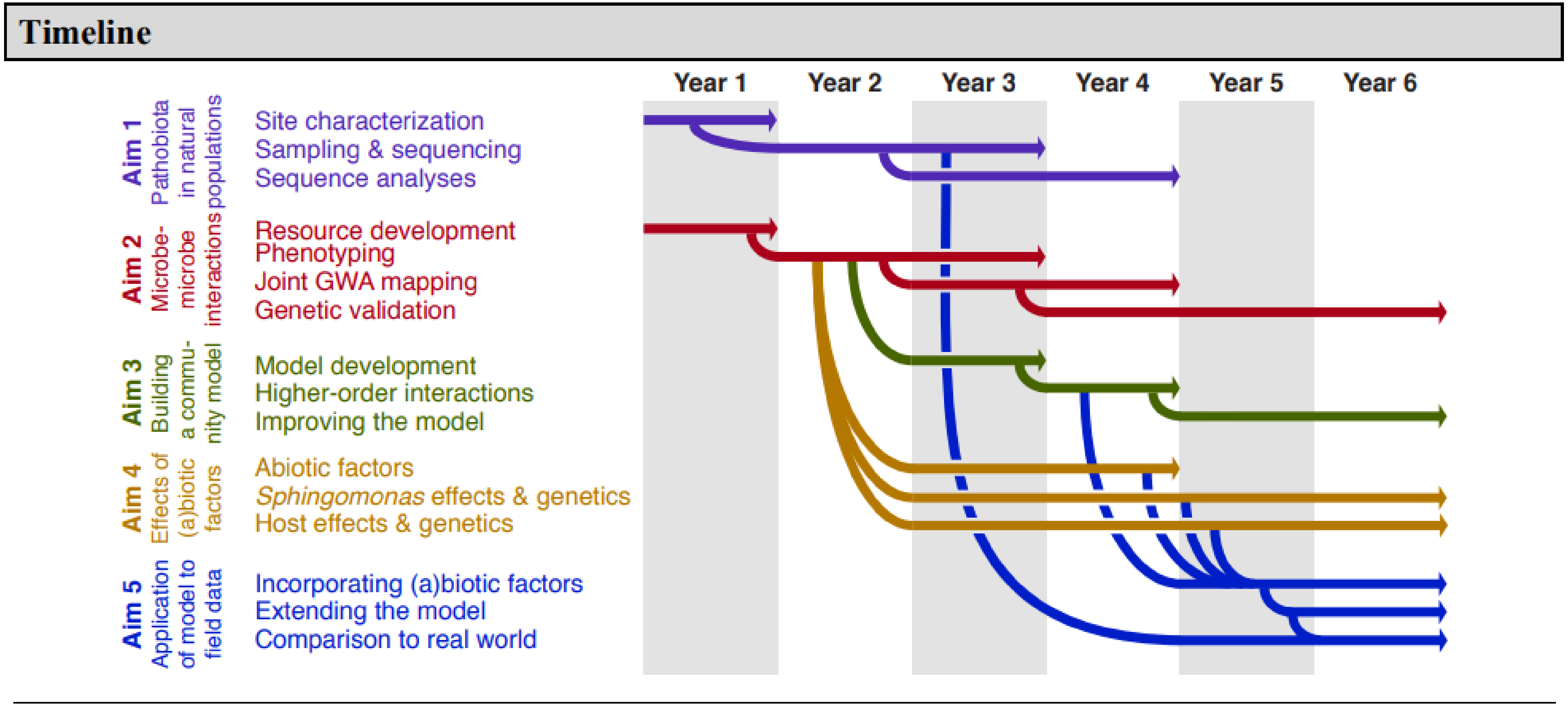
Methodology – Research/work plan

❑ **Outline your Research Plan**
- Clearly describe the experimental design and methods.
- Follow the same structure of the objectives.
- Explain how the data will be collected, analyzed and interpreted.
- Identify key results or "deliverables"

❑ **Other components to describe**
- Timeline
- Graphic representation of research plan
- Risks and contingency plan
- Sex and gender dimension in research
- Research Data Management



Gantt Chart (timeline) example



PATHOCOM ERC Synergy funded grant: https://figshare.com/articles/preprint/PATHOCOM_proposal/13174337

Risks and contingencies

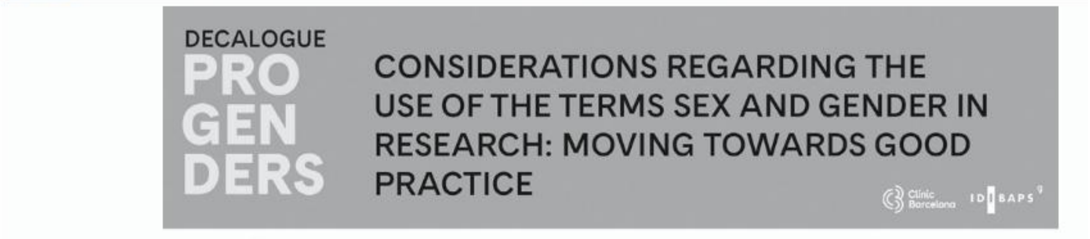
- Identify risks that could potentially jeopardize the achievement of the project goals
- Describe the contingency plan for each identified risk
- Define the likelihood for each risk to occur
- Types of risks: scientific, technical, management, coordination, exploitation, conceptual

Sex, gender and intersectional analysis in research

- Sex refers to biological characteristics and gender to social/cultural attitudes, behaviors and identities.
- Intersectionality describes interdependent systems of inequality related to sex, gender, race, age, class and other socio-political dimensions.
- Sex, gender and intersectionality are potentially critical factors in the experimental design in science, in multiple disciplines, increasing quality and efficiency of research.

https://genderedinnovations.stanford.edu/index.html

Table 1. PROGENDERS Decalogue of recommendations on the gender perspective in research



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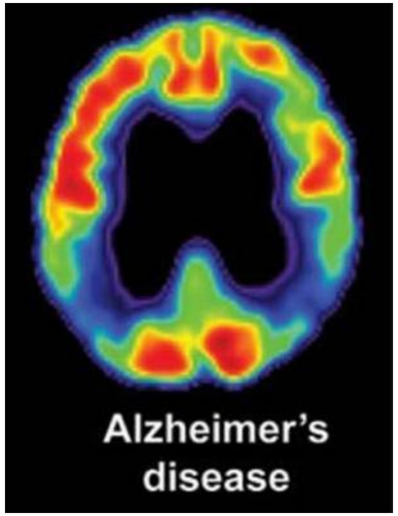
Sex and Gender: Alzheimer's Disease Case Study

SEX (Biology)

- Higher lifetime risk in women
- Menopause & estrogen changes
- Differences in amyloid/tau pathology
- Potentially different treatment responses



GENDER (Society)

- Caregiving burden
- Education & cognitive reserve
- Healthcare access
- Lifestyle and social engagement

INTERSECTIONALITY (Society, environment)

- Race and ethnicity
- Socio-economic status
- Education
- Occupation

Disease risk → **Biomarkers** → **Precision therapies**

Research Data Management Plan (DMP)

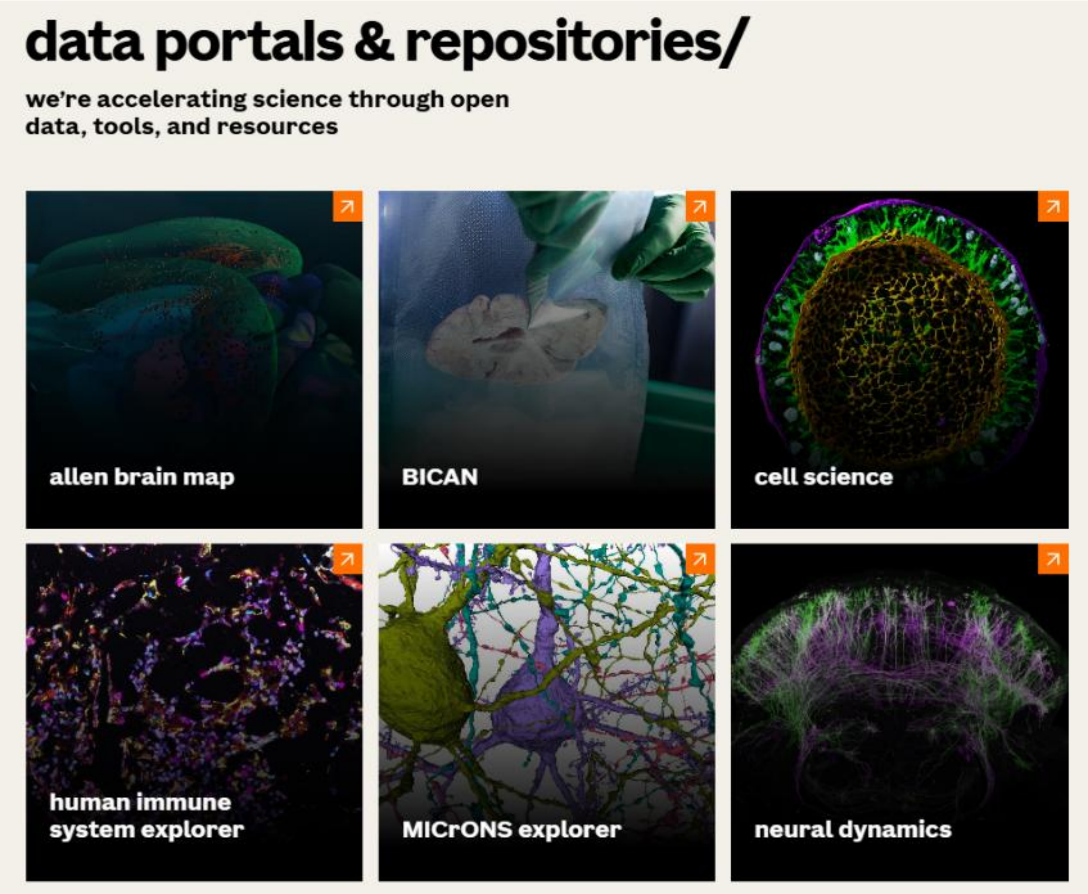
- "Living document", written before starting a Project and regularly updated.
- Collection and documentation: type, format and volume of the data.
- FAIR principles – Findable, Accessible, Interoperable and Reusable
- Legal and security issues: protection of personal data, etc.
- Data sharing: what data to share? With whom? When?
- Medium and long-term preservation: persistent identifiers, repositories (Re3data)

Momentos

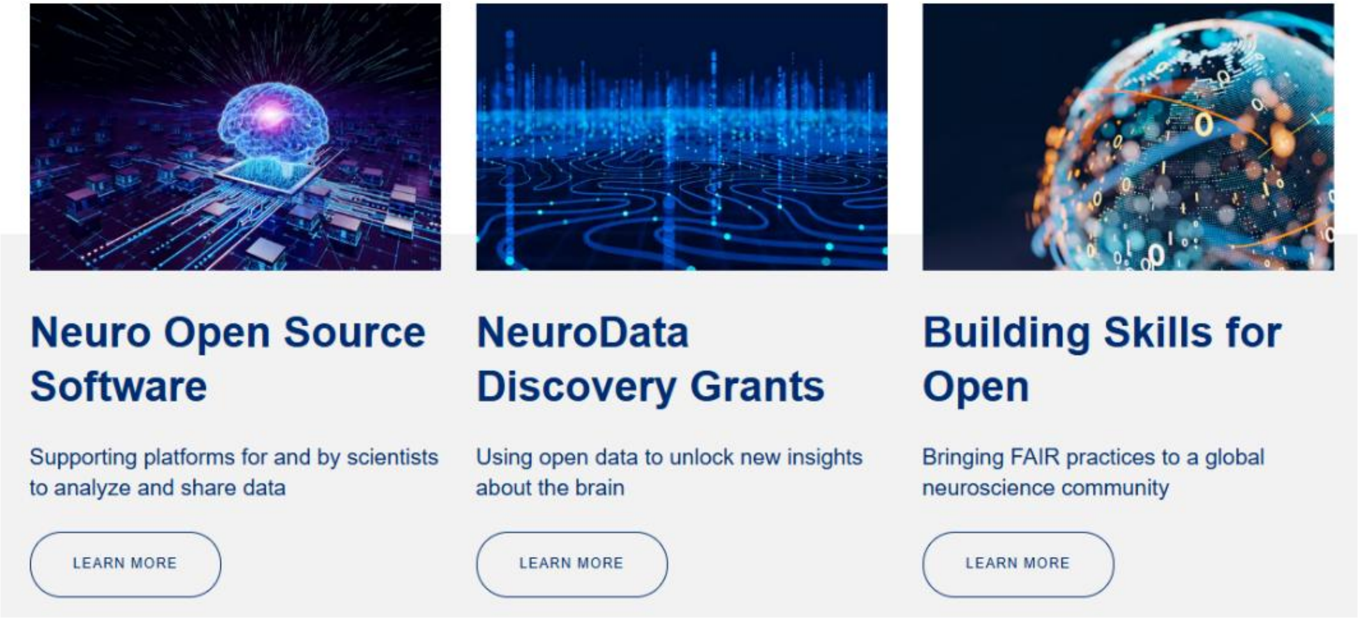
- **Lost Data**: Researcher can't find data, stored unlabeled in moving boxes.
- **Obsolete Format**: Data sent in unreadable hexadecimal from defunct software.
- **Missing Guide**: Field names unclear; only co-author knew, but he's unreachable.

[Bing Vídeos]

Open Data in neuroscience



[Science Resources | Allen Institute]



[Open Data in Neuroscience | Kavli Foundation]

TIPS - Budget

- Understand the funder’s guidelines
- Be Realistic but Conservative - Avoid both overestimating and underestimating
- Justify every item – personnel, consumable, equipment (if allowed), etc.
- Align Budget with Project Goals
- Look for institutional suport - collaborate with your institution’s finance or grants office

Expected results, outcomes and impact

Research activities

↓

Outputs

Generated Results

↓

Outcomes

Finite and often measurable change

↓

Impact

The longer term effect of an outcome

Omics experiments

⇩

Biomarker identification of colorectal cancer through liquid biopsy

⇩

Further development of diagnostic assay usable in the clinical practice

⇩

Better disease prevention and reduction of healthcare costs

Communication | Dissemination | Exploitation

Communication	Dissemination	Exploitation	
Reach out to society and show the impact and benefits of EU-funded R&I activities, e.g. by addressing and providing possible solutions to fundamental societal challenges.	**Transfer knowledge & results** with the aim to enable others to use and take up results, thus maximising the impact of EU-funded research.	**Effectively use project results** through scientific, economic, political or societal exploitation routes aiming to turn R&I actions into concrete value and impact for society.	Objective
Inform about and promote the project AND its results/success.	**Describe** and **ensure results available** for others to **USE** ➡ focus on results only!	**Make concrete use** of research results (not restricted to commercial use.)	Focus
Multiple audiences beyond the project's own community incl. media and the broad public.	Audiences that may take an interest in the potential **USE** of the results (e.g. scientific community, industrial partner, policymakers).	People/organisations including project partners themselves that make concrete use of the project results, as well as user groups outside the project.	Target Audience

TIPS – Impact

- Focus on **who** benefits and **how**
- **Quantify**: scale and significance
- Think long-term
- Align with **funder´s priorities**

TIPS – Some common pitfalls

- Misalignment with the funder´s priorities
- Not following the instructions
- Unrealistic project within proposed timeframe and budget
- *Objectives*: too ambitious or unclear and vague
- *Approach*: unfeasible; not related to the expertise of the applicant.

Active poll

12

What are the most relevant take home messages for you about grant writing?

Opportunity 5 | Review 3 | Research 3 | Clear 3

- 1. Understanding funders priorities and review criteria
  2. Understanding opportunities that aligned with your area of research
  3. Inviting home reviewers (colleagues/mentors) before sending application.
  4. Structuring the proposal with clear sections for easy understanding for both specialists and generalists

- Identifying your research niche and understand the funders niche to ensure the alignment in interest.
  Creating a balance and demonstrate credibility

- 1. The different types of research grant opportunities
  2. Tips on general grant writing

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Institut D'Investigacions Biomèdiques August Pi i Sunyer

Active poll

12

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What are the most relevant take home messages for you about grant writing?

Opportunity 5 | Review 3 | Research 3 | Clear 3

- Tell a clear story, prove feasibility with data, address reviewer priorities explicitly, and revise relentlessly. Make their job easy clarity beats complexity every time.
- Alligning grant proposal with expertise and reaching out to mentors before writing and clear and feasible idea and some grants are qualifications based
- As a newbie in neuroscience, I understand that i still have the chance and opportunity to further my research and career
- Project impact and the ability to communicate it clearly to reviewers with different expertise is key.

IDIBAPS

Active poll

12

What are the most relevant take home messages for you about grant writing?

Opportunity 5 | Review 3 | Research 3 | Clear 3

- The most important take home for me is that opportunities are everywhere and it takes adequate preparations and thorough writing to harness one or more of these opportunities.
  Thank you
- Start small and grow gradually through it
- You can get a competitive grant if you plan your timeline and present a beautiful case for your application
- Write clearly use generative Ai responsively

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Wishing you much success in your next grant!
bertero@recerca.clinic.cat
May the Force be with you…